

Theatre Cue Player

Show control for school theatre · a classroom training tool

theatrecueplayer.app

TWO WAYS TO RUN IT

Chrome extension

The full thing: audio, video, projection mapping, text cues, second-screen output, a sound editor, cue list backups, optional Google Drive. Install from the Chrome Web Store.

Browser version

Audio only, nothing to install. Runs from a link or a USB stick, with no admin rights and no internet. Works where extensions are blocked.

Both free for the 2026–27 school year. After that, only second-screen projection output carries a fee. Audio-only shows stay free.

ASK IT BEFORE THE UNIT

- **Extensions:** managed Chromebooks often block installs. IT can allow or push the extension from the Google Admin console.
- **Google Drive mode:** allow theatrecueplayer.app through the web filter, and the app in Google Admin.
- **Chromebooks that wipe at sign-out** lose shows saved on the computer. Use Drive or a USB stick.

FEATURE HIGHLIGHTS

- **Drag sound files onto the cue list:** each becomes a cue named after its file. (Browser version: Load Audio Folder, in file-name order.)
- **GO / Spacebar:** fires the next cue. Drill it early; timing is everything.
- **Auto-Continue** starts the next cue at the same moment. **Auto-Follow** starts it when this one ends.
- **Fade cues** target another cue and fade it to a level; "stop cue when done", as in QLab.
- **Loops, hotkeys** for instant effects, and a **waveform editor** for trims and fades.
- **Edit Mode off** = show mode. **Help Mode** explains every control; teach students to look there first.
- **Backups:** the last 20 cue lists, one each time a show opens. **Export Project to Zip** packs the cue list and every file.
- **Video** (extension): H.264 MP4 near 1080p. Phone video looking dark? Use the cue's HDR fix.

KEYBOARD SHORTCUTS

Space	GO
Esc	STOP ALL
Shift + Esc	FADE ALL
P	PAUSE ALL / RESUME ALL (<i>extension</i>)
Enter	Play the selected cue
Backspace	Stop the selected cue
F	Fade the most recent cue
↑ ↓	Move the selection
E	Edit Mode on / off
Ctrl + S	Save
Ctrl + Z / Y	Undo / Redo

The same keys in both versions.

TEACHING NOTES

More sound ≠ better design. Excessive or irrelevant cues dilute impact. Quality and intentional placement always win.

Auto-Continue vs. Auto-Follow: clarify the difference early. It's the most common point of confusion.

Copyright: students document ALL audio sources in a README.txt inside their zip. If they can't confirm a license, they can't use it.

File naming matters: 01_Alley_Ambience_loop.wav. Numbered prefixes keep cue order aligned with the script.

Sound files: MP3, WAV, OGG, M4A, FLAC. Not WMA.

LICENSE

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Website



Chrome extension



Browser version



Video guides

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Theatre Cue Player

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Sound Design Project

A Theatre Cue Player classroom project · theatrecueplayer.app

PROJECT OVERVIEW

Students create a complete sound design for an assigned scene, programming intentional cues that support mood, setting, and action, then present and defend their choices to the class.

4-DAY PACING GUIDE

Day	Teacher	Students	Deliverable
1	Demo TCP (0–20 min): load sounds, add cues, waveform editor, Auto-Continue, fades, export. Copyright sources overview.	Independent exploration + initial cue plan (20–45 min).	Cue plan or timeline screenshot.
2	Recap. Mini-conferences: check programming & annotations.	Place ambient, action, transition cues; set Auto-Continue + Fade. Peer listening pairs.	Saved project + updated annotated script.
3	Recap. Final check before export (45–50 min).	Refine timing, volume automation, file naming. Peer feedback stations.	Project ready for export.
4	Record rubric scores during runs.	Present scene (5–7 min each): run program, readers read lines, explain 3 design + 1 technical choice.	Zip submission + peer feedback.
5*	*Optional overflow.	Extra presentations, troubleshooting, or extended peer sharing.	—

REQUIRED ELEMENTS

- **6+ sound cues** that justify mood, setting, or action
- **1 Auto-Continue** for ambient/layered tracks across scene beats
- **1 Fade** (in or out), typically 1–8 sec depending on cue type
- **1 Intentional Volume Change** via a fade cue, not just clip gain
- **Annotated script:** cue labels match file names; include start, stop/fade, volume notes
- **Zip submission:** project file + audio files + annotated script + README.txt with source credits

SCRIPT ANNOTATION FORMAT

```
[SFX 2: Thunder_Heavy.wav – start at line 3;
fade out 4s after line 6; vol -3dB] "He looked
up at the sky."
```

FILE NAMING CONVENTION

```
01_Alley_Ambience_loop.wav
02_Footsteps_gravel.wav
03_Door_squeak_fadeout.wav
```

FORMATIVE CHECK QUESTIONS

- Which moment needs a sound cue, and why?
- Where will you use silence for effect?
- Show me where Auto-Continue, Fade, or Volume Change appears in your cue list.

COPYRIGHT RULES

- Royalty-free, public domain, or explicitly licensed for reuse only
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- If you can't confirm the license, don't use it



Freesound.org



BBC Sound Effects



Pixabay Sounds



ZapSplat

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